

ETHAN (TAEHOON) LEE

ethantlee21@gmail.com · thdxg.dev

Dear LFX Mentorship Committee

Thank you for taking your time to review my application. I'd like this letter to be a chance to share my motivation for this program.

Last Fall, I attended my first KubeCon in Atlanta. KubeCon was full of maintainers of fascinating open-source projects that I had been using every day for my Kubernetes homelab: ArgoCD, OpenTelemetry, Cilium, Tailscale, and much more. But the most inspiring experience was meeting people who kindly offered to guide me through the open-source world. One of them was Nitish Kumar, who shared how LFX Mentorship helped him become part of the CNCF community and now a core maintainer of ArgoCD.

I am interested in LFX Mentorship because I want to become an engineer like Nitish: one whose expertise opens the door for other people. I want to contribute to projects that I care about and inspire more students like me to be part of the community. As I enter my Master's program in computer science, I believe this opportunity would help me grow personally and professionally.

I am a developer who works across the stack from low-level systems to user-facing products. Most of my recent focus has been into Huddle Surety, where I'm founding engineer and CTO. Leading a team of engineers, I've architected an AI-native platform that automates surety bond issuance in Go, TypeScript, and Python. I shipped the frontend using TypeScript and React, built 100+ REST API endpoints in Go with Redis caching and ReBAC authorization, and provisioned end-to-end observability with OpenTelemetry and LGTM stack. Whichever part of the stack I was working on, I cared most about reliability and performance.

Outside work, I enjoy working close to the metal, such as building a terminal emulator or running a Kubernetes homelab on Raspberry Pis. I've also contributed to open-source projects like Next.js, Kubernetes website, and Go Echo framework as I find gaps while working with them professionally and personally. Working in open source has helped me mature as an engineer with discipline and rigor taking responsibility of widely used products.

I believe my array of skills in Go development, OpenTelemetry, and platform engineering align well with adding declarative configuration support for otelc. I am excited to be part of the CNCF community and confident that I would bring significant value to this project.

Sincerely,

Ethan (Taehoon) Lee